THE DUDELA CO.

Her Copy

The Prep Kit, partner edition. Your side of the plan.



Your side of the plan.

PREPARE TOGETHER.

Seven short worksheets. Fill them out on your own, then compare notes with him.

John & Mike | The Dudela Co.

WELCOME

This one’s for you.

He’s working through the Prep Kit. These pages are your half of it.

Hey. We’re John and Mike, two dads who wrote the Prep Kit for expecting dads. If you’re reading this, he’s working on it. Good.

Here’s the problem we kept seeing. The dad fills out a worksheet about what his partner needs, and then he has to guess. Or he hands the worksheet to her, and now she’s doing his homework on top of growing a person. Neither one helps.

So this is your copy

These pages ask you the same questions his pages ask him, from your side. What feels heavy. What you want him to own. What matters to you during the birth. What you’re hoping the first days home look like.

How to use it

Fill it out on your own time, in pencil, as honestly as you like. Skip anything that doesn’t fit your family. Then sit down together, put the two copies side by side, and look for the gaps. The last page walks you through that.

> **What we hope you get out of it**
>
> A partner who doesn’t have to guess, and a plan that sounds like both of you, not just him.

This isn’t a test for either of you. It’s a starting point for a better conversation.

START HERE

Your thirty minutes.

You don’t need to finish it all at once.

First 10 minutes · Say where you are

Fill out your Readiness Map on the next page. Be honest about what feels unclear. Unclear is a useful answer.

Next 10 minutes · Say what you need

Fill out What I Need From You and What I Want Off My Plate. Be specific. “Help more” is hard to act on. “Own dinner on weeknights” is easy.

Last 10 minutes · Get ready to talk

Answer the questions on Before We Talk. Then pick a time with him to compare notes, using the last page.

> **Your minimum useful result**
>
> He knows the one thing that feels heaviest for you, the one task you want him to take over, and what you want from him in the delivery room.

YOUR TOOL 01 OF 07

Your Readiness Map

Circle one status in each row. This is how it feels to you, not how it should look.

AREA	STATUS	WHAT WOULD HELP
How I'm feeling, and my support	Ready / Working / Unclear	
Leave and money	Ready / Working / Unclear	
Who handles what at home	Ready / Working / Unclear	
The birth and our contacts	Ready / Working / Unclear	
What I need from him	Ready / Working / Unclear	
The first days home	Ready / Working / Unclear	

The thing weighing on me most right now

What I wish he already knew about it

One thing he could do this week that would make a real difference

DONE MEANS

You've named the heaviest thing and one action he can take. You don't have to have solved anything yet.

YOUR TOOL 02 OF 07

What I Need From You

For the hard moments: how to tell when I'm overloaded, and what actually helps.

When I'm overwhelmed, it usually looks like

What helps me in that moment

What doesn't help, even when you mean well

How I'd like you to check in on me, and how often

How I'll tell you I'm not okay, even if I don't say it outright

PEOPLE IN MY CORNER BESIDES YOU	HOW TO REACH THEM	WHAT I'D ASK THEM FOR

DONE MEANS

He knows your early signs, what helps, and what to skip. You have at least one person besides him you can lean on.

YOUR TOOL 03 OF 07

What I Want Off My Plate

Owning something means noticing it, planning it, doing it, and following through, without reminders.

RESPONSIBILITY	I'D LIKE HIM TO OWN IT	WHAT DONE LOOKS LIKE TO ME
Meals and groceries	Yes / Share / Mine	
Laundry and cleaning	Yes / Share / Mine	
Hospital bags and prep	Yes / Share / Mine	
Visitors and family updates	Yes / Share / Mine	
Appointments and paperwork	Yes / Share / Mine	
Baby gear and setup	Yes / Share / Mine	
Other	Yes / Share / Mine	

The one thing I'm ready to hand over completely this week

What I'll need to let go of supervising, so it's really his

What we could simplify or stop doing for now

DONE MEANS

You've picked one responsibility to hand over fully. He knows what done looks like to you, so neither of you has to keep checking.

YOUR TOOL 04 OF 07

Before We Talk

Your answers to the same questions his Partner Conversation asks. Bring this page.

What feels heaviest for me right now

What he’s doing that helps, and one thing I’d change

What I’m worried about but haven’t said

What I want around visitors, privacy, and family updates

When we’re both tired, how I want us to ask for help or repair an argument

DONE MEANS

You walk into the conversation already knowing what you want to say, so the time goes to listening and deciding, not starting from zero.

YOUR TOOL 05 OF 07

My Birth Preferences

Your own words. This supports a conversation with your care team; it is not consent or a medical order.

What matters most to me during the birth

What I want from him when I'm uncomfortable or scared

What I don't want, from him or anyone else in the room

Preferences I want to discuss with the care team

If the plan changes, what I want him to handle

Who gets updates, when, and who doesn't

DONE MEANS

He can explain your preferences back to you in his own words. Medical questions are marked for your care team. You both know preferences can change, and that's allowed.

YOUR TOOL 06 OF 07

The First Days Home

Draft it now. Update it with your discharge instructions.

NEED	WHAT I'M HOPING FOR, AND WHO HANDLES IT
Rest, and how we take turns	
Feeding support	
My recovery and comfort	
Nights	
Meals, water, and the house	
Visitors and family	
Time for myself	

What I'm most nervous about once we're home

If I'm not feeling like myself, what I want him to do

DONE MEANS

He knows what you're hoping the first week looks like and what to do if it gets hard. You both know who to call. The care resources on the last page are a good place to start.

YOUR TOOL 07 OF 07

Compare Notes

Put your copy next to his. Thirty minutes, something to drink, phones away.

Step one · Readiness Maps side by side

Where did you circle the same thing? Where did one of you say Ready and the other say Unclear? Those gaps are the conversation.

Step two · Hand over one thing

Read him What I Want Off My Plate. He picks it up fully, and you agree on what done looks like.

Step three · Walk through the birth

Read your Birth Preferences out loud. He explains them back. Mark anything for the care team.

WHERE WE AGREE	WHERE WE SEE IT DIFFERENTLY	ONE DECISION WE MADE

Keep the right help close

CDC Hear Her lists urgent warning signs during pregnancy and in the year after delivery. If anything feels wrong, call your care team or get emergency help. Ask your health professional about anxiety, low mood, or not feeling like yourself; that goes for both of you.

Read CDC urgent maternal warning signs →

cdc.gov/hearher/maternal-warning-signs

> **From our families to yours**
>
> Thanks for doing your half. The plan works better with both of you in it. John & Mike